

Yellow Leaf Curl Virus - YLCV



⚠️ **Note :** Our AI helps quickly identify plant diseases, but it isn't 100% accurate. Results depend heavily on image quality —blurry photos can confuse the model. Always verify the final diagnosis with a qualified plant expert..

About disease and the symptoms

Yellow leaf curl virus (often called TYLCV) is a devastating viral disease that severely disrupts how a plant grows.

The most important thing to know about this virus is how it travels. It is not spread by wind or splashing rain; it is entirely spread by tiny insects called silverleaf whiteflies. When these tiny white bugs feed on an infected plant, they suck up the virus and then inject it directly into the next healthy plant they snack on!

Because this is a virus affecting the plant's internal systems, the symptoms look much more like physical deformities rather than spots or mold. Here is what to watch for:

Upward Curling: The most classic sign! The newest leaves at the top of the plant will begin to curl upward and inward, making them look like little green cups or spoons.

Yellow Margins: The edges of the leaves will turn distinctly pale or yellow, while the veins running through the center often remain green.

Stunted Growth: The virus severely stunts the plant. The stems stop growing tall, the leaves stay very small, and the whole plant takes on a crinkled, bunched-up, or bushy appearance.

Flower Drop: If the plant tries to produce flowers, they will usually dry up and fall off before they can ever form fruit.

Treatment

Because yellow leaf curl is a viral infection running through the plant's entire system, there is absolutely no cure or chemical treatment to save a plant once it is infected, making swift removal your only option! To protect the rest of your garden, you must immediately pull up and securely bag the sick plants—never compost them—so the virus source is completely gone. Since the disease is spread exclusively by insects, your next critical step is to aggressively target the whiteflies by hanging yellow sticky traps and coating the remaining healthy plants with neem oil or insecticidal soap. Moving forward, your best defense against this devastating virus is to plant specific disease-resistant varieties (look for 'TYLCV' on the seed packet) and lay down reflective silver mulch, which disorients the whiteflies and stops them from landing in the first place!

